

COSMETIC BOOSTERS

Use wallpaper randomisers to frequently change your wallpapers and also alter the frequency mode and effects

BackFlip

This nifty program allows you to change wallpapers at specified intervals. It offers a wide slicing of time, ranging from a few seconds to a few days, and it's easy to install and configure

Setting the source

Click on the system tray icon to launch BackFlip. Click on the 'Source' tab. Now, add an image, an entire folder of images, or the URL of a wallpaper site in the images library. There are a few wallpapers in BackFlip's image library but they're not stored locally. The source points to an FTP site on www.fcodersoft.com.

The last icon on the menu, which resembles a monitor, allows you to select an image and set it as the current wallpaper. The 'Pause' button allows you to suspend or continue the wallpaper cycling session.

Changing display mode and effects

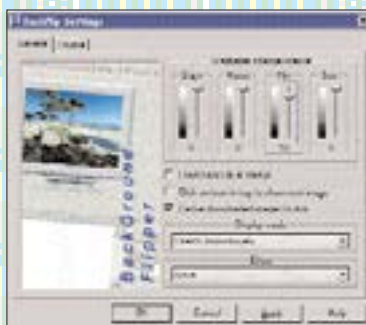
Wallpapers can be a mix-and-match of different resolutions. You can stretch the wallpaper to fit the desktop, use the tile option, or keep the wallpaper in the centre using the 'Display mode' option in the 'General' tab. You can also choose from six different effects in the 'Effects' drop down list.

Setting the frequency

The 'General' tab in the BackFlip window allows you to set the time interval (seconds, minutes, hours or days) for cycling the wallpapers. Just pull down the slider on any of the four 'Change interval' options and set your preferred interval for the wallpaper change.

Cache images

When you add URLs to the image library, the software tries to fetch the image from the Web site every time while randomising, thus the image takes much longer to load. In order to reduce the time,

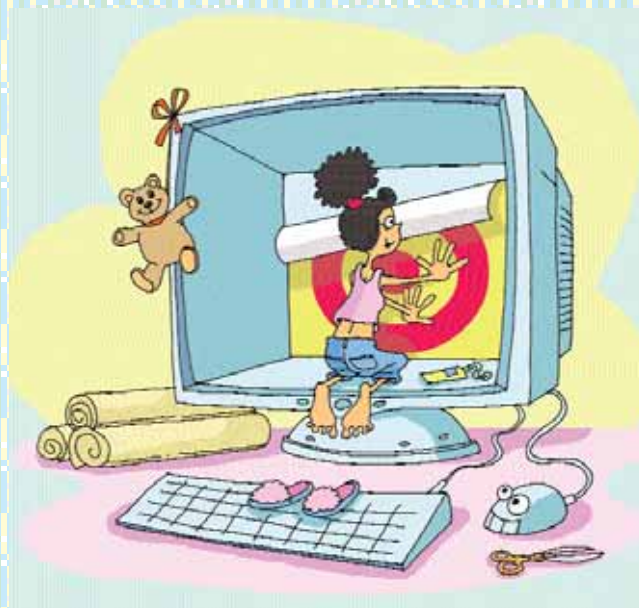


Set the interval for change

choose the 'Cache downloaded images to disk' option from the 'General' tab and the image will be loaded in a jiffy the next time the software tries to seek an image during a cycle.

Stop randomising

At any point of time if you



need to stop the wallpaper cycling, right-click on the BackFlip icon in the system tray and choose 'Suspend Show'. You can resume the cycling process the same way by clicking the 'Continue show' option.

WallMaster

WallMaster is another great wallpaper randomiser. This software has some neat features that BackFlip lacks. Use them to your advantage

Clear the wallpaper

If at any point of time you do not want any wallpaper on your screen, simply right-click the WallMaster icon on the system tray and choose 'Clear Wallpaper'. This will show just the background colour on your desktop.



Go slow

■ A new wallpaper every few minutes looks nice. But when the software is loading the image, your PC tries to repaint the entire screen with the new image. This takes CPU time and your PC might slow down considerably. You might even notice flickering or some distortion on the screen. Hence, it's advisable to set longer cycling intervals, say in the order of 15-20 minutes.

■ Though wallpapers are pretty add-ons, they are heavy and your computer will take longer to boot up. If you are performance conscious, avoid wallpapers.

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